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Tenants Vow To Continue Rent Strike

ROTTING STAIRWAY COLLAPSES AT LA PERALTA—BLACK MAN INJURED

(Oakland, Calif.) - A Black man was injured at the La Peralta apartments last week when a third floor bannister which the city Housing Conservation division had previously ordered the millionaire slumlord owner of the building to fix collapsed.

In other developments at the downtown Oakland residence, whose predominantly Black tenants have been engaged in a rent strike since last December 15 to protest the building's indecent housing conditions, an inspection was made of 15 apartments that owner William E. Nickerson agreed to repair in a court settlement last month. In few cases had any repairs been made.

Earl Adkins was visiting a relative who lives in the La Peralta last Saturday morning, February 18, when the bannister on the third floor steps in the rear of the building where he was walking collapsed. Adkins' screams of pain aroused several of the tenants, among them Kirmet Rooney, tenant spokesperson and organizer of the rent strike.

In early December, when a reporter and photographer from THE BLACK PANTHER first visited the La Peralta at Rooney's request,



Defective heater (above) and rotting stairway at La Peralta apartments.



one of the first deficiencies he showed them was this same bannister, which was falling apart at that time.

A report made to Nickerson on February 6 by

Assistant Housing Manager Warren Wildman concerning a full survey of the La Peralta made by the city on January 25 said, in part:

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"Attack" Manual To Get Addresses Of Militant Blacks

K.K.K. "DIRTY TRICKS" REVEALED

(Atlanta, Ga.) - David E. Duke, the media-conscious imperial wizard of a newly packaged Ku Klux Klan that is appealing for new members on the basis of "nonviolent" racism, admits that he and fellow Klansmen are the authors of an "attack" manual ascribed to a fictitious Black militant.

Duke denied in an interview that the manual, written under the name "Muhammad X" and carefully salted with misspellings and bad punctuation, was intended to stir racial animosities among Whites.

Instead, he said, it was intended to allow the Klan to compile, through mail-order sales, a list of "radical Blacks" that it could use in the event of racial warfare, which Duke said he and his followers were sure would occur.

He declined to say precisely how the Klan would use the list, but the implications are obvious — ominous.

The manual, called "African Atto" — translated as "African Attack" — is copyrighted in the name of C.E. Hardin, the



Ku Klux Klan cross burning.

maiden name of Duke's wife, Chloe, the *New York Times* reports.

In the interview in New Orleans, where Duke's group, one of a dozen often bitterly competitive Klan groups, has its headquarters, he was asked if he knew of the book. He said he did, and the following exchange took place:

Q: "Who wrote it?"

A: "Well, some people associated with me."

Q: "Why?"

A: "Specifically, because we wanted to compile a list of Blacks who were involved in racist activities against White people. The ads that sold this book were very racist, and the most radical Blacks who were opposed to White people."

Q: "It's purportedly by someone called Muhammad X, but it's really by your people, by you, actually?"

A: "It's not actually written by me."

Q: "(Chloe Duke) holds the copyright, but this is a manual that purports to be —

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